

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mrs Danielle HEBRARD

Address: 29 Balmoral Way Sutton SM2 6PD

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer objects to the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: I wish to object strongly to the above planning application. My husband and I have lived on the nearby Balmoral Way (a cul de sac) for nearly 33 years and we chose this particular road because of its quiet residential location and appeal.

The local Avenue Primary School has expanded significantly over the years from 400 pupils to over 1000 resulting in it having a wider catchment area. This unfortunately, has generated a huge increase in traffic at the junction of Avenue Road/Holland Avenue and Dorset Road during the school drop off and pick up times. These include not only the start and end of the school day but also the breakfast club/after school club and the nursery which operates on a half-day basis. On these occasions, the junction becomes impassable and nearby residents such as ourselves are unable to get out of our road as it is the sole exit point. It is virtually opposite the disused Ambulance Station and adjacent to this junction. Many drivers also choose to do their 3 point turns at this particular spot which add to the congestion.

Whilst we try our best to avoid using our car at these times, it is sometimes impossible to do so if hospital appointments or family emergencies dictate otherwise.

What I have witnessed at peak times is truly alarming whether on foot or by car. Vehicles are parked all the way up and down the adjoining roads even on the corners of the junction (in spite of the double yellow lines) and across people's drives. Sometimes, the ice cream van is there too, depending on the weather. There are so many parents, children and buggies that they are spilling off the pavement into the roads and into the paths of oncoming vehicles.

The visibility is severely restricted, so much so, that there have been not only near misses but

actual accidents over recent years at this junction. My fear is that before long, someone is going to be badly injured. The S2 and S4 bus routes are also badly affected. Sometimes they simply can't navigate through and, on occasions fail to stop to allow passengers off.

Having a place of worship, irrespective of faiths, in this location is in my opinion totally illogical and unjustified. Balmoral Way is also a narrow winding road with some spaces for cars to park but if they are wide vehicles or are badly parked, it becomes impossible to drive through. I have on occasions had to abandon my car temporarily as a result.

My concern is also how would an emergency vehicle get through if there were to be a further increase in traffic. We also have a few elderly and less able residents who require carers on a regular basis and they would be severely impacted in such a situation.